

API Error Handling and Reliability

Backend development study note for document retrieval and grounded question-answering practice.

Error responses

A useful API error response communicates the problem without exposing secrets or internal implementation details. Consistent error formats make client handling easier.

Timeouts and retries

Timeouts prevent clients from waiting indefinitely. Retries can help with transient failures, but should use bounded attempts and backoff. Retrying operations with side effects requires special care.

Validation and observability

Validate incoming data and return suitable client errors for invalid requests. Log useful diagnostic information while avoiding credentials and sensitive data. Metrics and traces help investigate latency and failures.